

Yuyuan Yu (余雨缘)

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EDUCATION

City University of Hong Kong <i>PhD candidate in Economics</i>	2022 - 2027 (Expected) Hong Kong SAR, China
Central University of Finance and Economics <i>MA in Economics</i>	2018 - 2020 Beijing, China
Zhongnan University of Economics and Law <i>BA in Economics</i>	2014 - 2018 Wuhan, China

RESEARCH INTERESTS

General interests: International Trade, Environmental, Urban and Development Economics

Special focus: Trade policy, firm dynamics, transportation, crime, and pollutants

JOB MARKET PAPER

“Evading the Ban: Smuggling, Pollution, and Firm Performance Under Waste Import Restrictions”, with Hanwei Huang, selected for the International Seminar on Trade 2026 (organized by the *Journal of International Economics*, University of Geneva, the World Bank, and the CEPR).

Abstract: While import restrictions are increasingly deployed to achieve non-trade objectives such as environmental protection, they often create distortions and leakage through illicit trade. We examine this trade-off in the context of China’s waste import ban. Although the policy produced measurable reductions in pollution, it also induced significant behavioral responses, including surging evasion via quantity underreporting, heightened smuggling-related criminal activity, and deteriorating performance among affected firms. To quantify the welfare effects, we develop a hybrid sufficient-statistic framework that integrates reduced-form evasion elasticities with structural estimates of shadow costs. We find that the environmental gains more than offset the costs of smuggling and losses from distortions.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- [1] **Yu, Y.**, Qayyum, M., and Li, S. (2024). Trade dynamics of environmental goods within global energy economy and their impacts on green technological innovation: A complex network analysis. *Energy Economics*, 140, 107957.
- [2] Zhang, Y., Qayyum, M., and **Yu, Y.** (2023). Effects of resource abundance on economic complexity: Evidence from spatial panel model. *Journal of Cleaner Production*, 427, 139134.
- [3] **Yu, Y.**, and Qayyum, M. (2023). Impacts of financial openness on economic complexity: Cross-country evidence. *International Journal of Finance and Economics*, 28(2), 1514-1526.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Dam Good for Trade”, with Hanwei Huang, Yu-Hsiang Lei, and Yan Lei.

FELLOWSHIP AND AWARDS

Postgraduate Student Scholarship , City University of Hong Kong	2022-2026
Outstanding Academic Performance Award , City University of Hong Kong	2025

PRESENTATIONS

AEA, Washington (planned)	2027
Asian Economic Development Conference (AEDC), Hong Kong	2026
Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society, East & Southeast Asia (AMES-E/SE), Hanoi	
12th Hong Kong Economic Association (HKEA) Biennial Conference, Macau	
Singapore Management University (SMU) Trade Conference, Singapore	
Economics Brown Bag, City University of Hong Kong	2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

City University of Hong Kong

Teaching Assistant, Advanced Macroeconomics	Fall 2026
Teaching Assistant, Managing Your Personal Finance	Spring 2026
Teaching Assistant, Microeconomics	Fall 2022, Fall 2023
Teaching Assistant, Green Economics	Fall 2023
Teaching Assistant, Macroeconomics	Spring 2023
Teaching Assistant, International Finance	Spring 2023

REFeree SERVICE

Applied Economics, Asia-Pacific Journal of Accounting and Economics, Review of Development Economics

SKILLS

Programming Languages

Stata, ArcGIS, LaTeX, Python

Languages

English (fluent), Mandarin (native)

REFEREES

Hanwei Huang (Supervisor)

Assistant Professor
Department of Economics and Finance
City University of Hong Kong
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Department of Economics and Finance
City University of Hong Kong
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Stephen Teng Sun

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